

Employment Services Options

A Guide for the Proper Definition and Sequencing of DVR and SDS Employment Services for SDS I/DD Waiver Recipients

**Note: While SDS waiver services are only available to individuals who are SDS waiver recipients who have gone through both that eligibility and waiver draw process, note that job center services are available to anyone and DVR services may be applicable to anyone with a substantial barrier to employment. Post-Secondary Transition Services are available to students eligible through IDEA. In addition, for individuals who have attained a developmental disability determination from SDS, but who are not yet a waiver recipient, there may be grant funds that they can pursue for supported employment services.*

Purpose & Scope:

Preface: This is a tool to assist providers, state agency staff, and consumers in following a sequence of employment related services. Not all recipients seeking employment related services will need all of the types listed. Service needs are determined through the person-centered process and assessment. The supports listed in this tool can be applied through the cycle of a recipient's need for employment services and supports including times of job loss or change. Note there are additional considerations for individuals of transition age (see page 12).

Purpose: The overarching goal of creating this employment services options document is to ensure that working age SDS I/DD waiver recipients (ages 16 and above) move quickly into integrated and competitive employment as described in Alaska State Law, SCS CSHB 211(L&C), the Employment First Act. Work is a fundamental part of adult life for people with and without disabilities. Meaningful work is associated with positive physical and mental benefits and is a critical component of being an active community member. In order to ensure that individuals with developmental disabilities realize their goal of integrated and competitive employment this matrix offers a visual model of how community supports might be best utilized. Time spent in each phase of this continuum will differ per recipient based on their individual work ready skills, interests, conditions of employment, needed supports and desired outcomes. As individuals progress along the employment continuum, the desired objective is fading support over time with the option to pursue a career change and/or advancement in their chosen field of work.

Scope:

- **SDS Pre-Vocational Services:**

- **When to utilize this service:** This service is to determine, in time limited terms (1 – 3 months), the recipient's basic work strengths/interests/skills for integrated, community based employment for which an individual is compensated at or above minimum wage. This includes assessment of their pre-vocational skills (work maturity/conceptual) and behaviors that may interfere with work. Pre-vocational services are intended to assist individuals with entering the general workforce and must be person-centered. Following this planning process, a recipient may move toward a variety of scenarios, including but not limited to:
 - **Next Step Scenario 1:** The recipient demonstrates adequate work maturity skills and may request to apply for DVR Services or seek help from the local job center. Note that after DVR or job center has been accessed, determination should be made whether the recipient will need long term employment support services to maintain their employment. If so, the recipient may access supported employment services through their IDD waiver.
 - **Next Step Scenario 2:** The recipient needs more time to develop adequate work maturity skills before requesting supports through DVR, job center, or applies for work independently, however, it is determined that with some more time limited (generally 3 months with some exceptions) development of work maturity skills and further career exploration, benefits advisement, volunteer work, etc., they will be prepared to enter into employment services.

- *Next Step Scenario 3:* Based on the Pre-Vocational assessment, the recipient does not exhibit the necessary pre-vocational skills and is not ready for a DVR referral. They will likely require additional time to gain the necessary pre-vocational skills needed for participation in employment services. The person centered process indicates that the recipient will likely need significantly more time than 3 months to gain work maturity skills needed for community based paid employment. The recipient may request SDS Day Habilitation Services to identify goals, objectives and specific amounts of time dedicated to attain the needed life and work maturity skills. This can include volunteer work to practice these skills when applicable. *A recipient's progression towards Pre-Employment readiness or a DVR referral should be continually evaluated by the team so that these services can be utilized as soon as is applicable.*
- **SDS & DVR* Pre-Employment Services:**
 - *When to utilize this service:* The recipient has work maturity skills, but needs some more time limited development and further career exploration, benefits advisement, or other identified services. (SDS is generally a 3 month lifetime limit with some exceptions; DVR* is applicable for in school youth ages 16-21 via Pre-Employment Transition Services)
 - Upon completion there are two tracks to consider:
 - *Next Step Scenario 1:* If the recipient's work maturity skills are determined to be ready for competitive and integrated employment, a referral to a job center or DVR should be made depending upon the individual's needs.
 - *Next Step Scenario 2:* If after more than one attempt to secure and maintain competitive employment the recipient's work maturity skills are determined to not be ready for competitive and integrated employment, additional time may be requested with proper justification.
 - 1.
- **Post-Secondary Transition Services (Public Schools)**
 - Applicable to all students eligible under the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA) beginning the year that the student turns 16, or younger, if determined appropriate by the school Individual Education Program team.
 1. the exploration of post-secondary goals
 2. the determination of strengths, interests and preferences
- **DVR Supported Employment Services:**
 - *When to utilize this service:* The recipient shows satisfactory work maturity skills and behaviors and wants job services; a DVR referral is appropriate at this time.
 - *Next Step Scenario 1:* Upon referral, recipient receives either general VR program services or VR supported employment services depending upon individual need so that integrated, competitive employment is achieved. Ticket-to-Work Job Center referral is made.

1. *Note that the recipient no longer needs services once placed into employment under VR's general program unless a job loss occurs, they are in jeopardy of losing their job and/or a significant change occurs with the job that requires assistance. If that occurs, VR's post-employment services may be utilized.*
- **Next Step Scenario 2:** The recipient is employed in an integrated and competitive job and determination is made whether the recipient will need long term employment support services to maintain employment. If the individual is served under DVR's supported employment services, long-term employment services must be in place as needed such as SDS Supported Employment Services. Ticket-to-Work Job Center referral is made for SS recipients.
 - **SDS Supported Employment Services (Stabilization and Support):**
 - **When to utilize this service:** The recipient has accessed services available through DVR, a job center, or other services and a determination was made that the recipient will need continued employment support services to maintain employment, prevent the loss of their job, or stabilize a recipient who had a change in their job situation. This service should have supports faded as is applicable based on the recipient's needs over time, such as showing progression towards employment independence.
 - *It should also be noted that the recipient could have a change in their job situation (i.e. having different duties to accomplish in their current job, career change to further grow in that field, etc.) that might necessitate the recipient to increase utilization of this service after supports had previously been faded or partially faded.*

Employment Services Options Flowchart

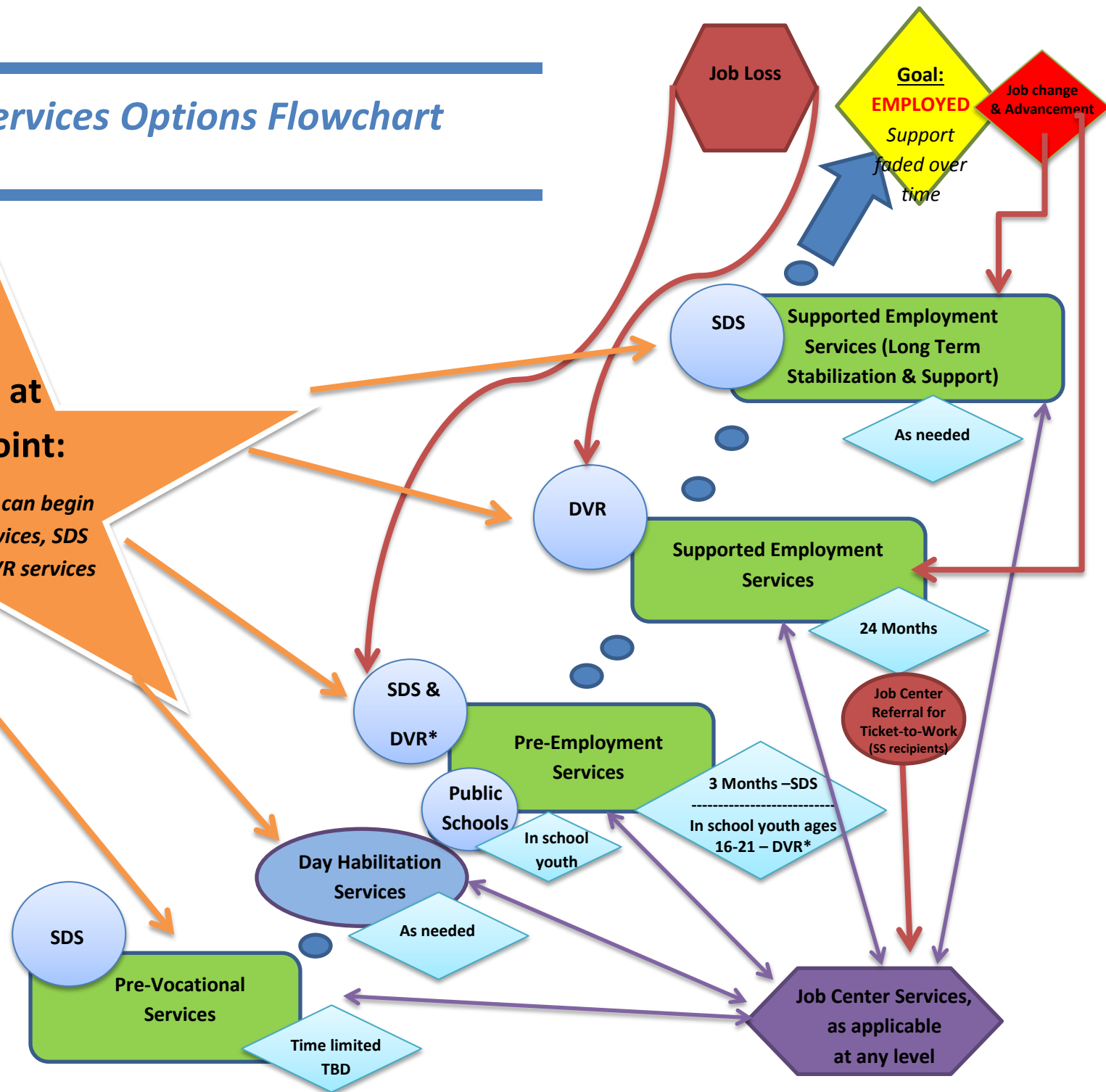
**Start at
Any Point:**

*An individual can begin
in school services, SDS
services or DVR services*

Transition Age

**see additional
considerations
on page 12*

Revised DRAFT 9/1/15



Additional Flowchart Points:

- This flowchart describes potential options available to a recipient who is SDS I/DD waiver eligible based on individual need.
- An individual can start at ***any*** point along this flow chart based on the applicability of the service to meet their needs (*i.e. an individual will not always start with SDS services simply because it is the first service listed, but instead should start with the service that best matches the current needs and work ready skill level*).
- Job Center services should be utilized at any point on this flow chart as is applicable based on the individual's unique needs.
 - Specific Ticket-to-Work Job Center referral should follow for Social Security (SS) recipients (after becoming employed via DVR services utilization or any other service where employment is achieved and long term supports are deemed beneficial)
- The purpose of this document and flow chart is to ensure people are matched (or have access) to the job services that lead to integrated community employment that is competitive. *Note that this will be different for each individual, but all services should follow this Alaska Employment First Law concept.*
- Some individuals may experience a job loss or career change and thus need to utilize services again or increase previously faded services. Likewise, an individual may wish to advance in a career and utilize services again.
- The overall goal of services is for the individual to be employed in integrated and competitive employment with supports fading over time to ensure the greatest level of self-sufficiency possible.

	SDS Pre-Vocational	SDS & DVR* Pre-Employment	DVR Services	SDS Supported Employment (Stabilization & Long-Term Support)
Services	- Assess interest in working (general areas of interest, number of hours of work desired) - Assess general skills and abilities relative to performing work and optimally to perform competitive, integrated employment - Assessment of pre-vocational skills needed for job success (conceptual skills and behaviors that interfere with work)	- General career exploration, including self-employment - Informational interviewing - Job search training - Job shadowing - Work readiness and maturity skill building - Work experience: - Volunteer/Paid - Job tryouts - Internships - Instruction in self-advocacy /Benefits Advisement (Tier 1 level) - Peer support and mentoring DVR* Pre-Employment Transition Services are available to in-school youth ages 16-21 only. Post-Secondary Transition Services are available to IDEA eligible students	- Vocational assessment such as aptitude & interest exploration, EYEG (Exploring Your Employment Goals) workshops, Discovery, etc. - Community-based assessment including on the job evaluation - Benefits Analysis (Tier 2 level) - Job search assistance - Job Readiness Training - Job placement assistance/job development - Job coaching - Job creation - Job carving - Skills training specific to the job - Self-Employment training, planning and start-up assistance - Peer support and mentoring - On the Job Training and/or job support services such as AT, tools, etc.	- Job coaching as needed - Employer check-in - Information & Referral as needed - Work Incentives counseling and assistance - Self-employment assistance and coaching - Career advancement services - Other workplace support services

Day Habilitation Service, as applicable, based on the needs of the recipient

	SDS Pre-Vocational	SDS & DVR* Pre-Employment	DVR Services	SDS Supported Employment (Stabilization & Long-Term Support)
Outcomes	▪ Assessment of the individual's interest in working and number of hours of work desired ▪ Assessment of the individuals' interest and ability to perform integrated, competitive employment ▪ Identification of pre-vocational skills the individual will need to master for job success ▪ Identification of behaviors that would interfere with work Determination of next applicable service on employment continuum (does not have to utilize every service, but rather should move to applicable level based on skills)	▪ Identification of jobs and careers of interest to the individual ▪ Building skills necessary to perform work and optimally to perform competitive, integrated employment, including some preliminary job search assistance if applicable ▪ Building Work Maturity/Work Readiness Skills Determination of next applicable service on employment continuum (does not have to utilize every service, but rather should move to applicable level based on skills)	▪ Paid employment at or above the minimum wage in an integrated setting in the general workforce, in a job that meets personal and career goals ▪ Self-employment in a business that meets personal and career goals ▪ Upon achieving employment, referral to Job Center Ticket-to-Work program would occur for Social Security recipients ▪ Determination of next applicable service on employment continuum (does not have to utilize every service, but rather should move to applicable level based on skills) ▪ Services can be utilized for career advancement in competitive employment or self-employment	▪ Sustained paid employment at or above the minimum wage in an integrated setting in the general workforce, in a job that meets personal and career goals ▪ Sustained self-employment in a business that meets personal and career goals ▪ Career advancement in competitive employment or self-employment

	SDS Pre-Vocational	SDS & DVR* Pre-Employment	DVR Services	SDS Supported Employment (Stabilization & Long-Term Support)
Funding	SDS	- SDS *DVR is an applicable funding source for Pre-Employment Transition Services for in-school youth with disabilities ages 16-21. - The individual may also seek supports through the job center or with peer supports	- DVR supported employment services Note: services are limited to 120 hours unless a VR manager approves additional hours) - DVR supported self-employment services (Tier I funding is available to an individual with a business plan concept requiring start-up costs of \$5,000 or less – Tier I requires an abbreviated business plan. Tier II funding (more than \$5,000) requires a comprehensive business plan and funding from sources other than DVR - Self-employment business funding may be sought via the Trust Microenterprise Grant up to a \$10,000 lifetime request limit with dollar for dollar match - SDS - but only if the individual is ineligible for DVR Services (Note: Medicaid funds may not be used to defray the expenses associated with starting up a business)	- SDS (Note: Medicaid funds may not be used to defray the expenses associated with operating a business) - DVR Post-Employment Services (services available to meet rehabilitation needs that do not require a complex and comprehensive provision of services and do not exceed two primary services and be more than six months in duration) - For Social Security recipients, the Job Center's Ticket-To-Work Program can provide some long term support services as well Note: For in school youth, after school and summer employment services may be funded by SDS if there is no duplication with what the school district provides.

	SDS Pre-Vocational	SDS & DVR* Pre-Employment	DVR Services	SDS Supported Employment (Stabilization & Long-Term Support)
Comments	3 month lifetime limit (funded in 15-minute increments for both individual and group pre-employment services) Note: the limit is currently awaiting a final determination as the service is in progress development - This service would be considered presumptively approved by SDS if it had not previously been utilized - Job Center resources should also be used to the extent available and the ticket to work program considered for individuals on Social Security - The following should be looked at, when applicable, in all service areas: - Natural supports - Technology	- SDS 3 month lifetime limit (funded in 15-minute increments for both individual and group pre-employment services) - Job Center resources should also be used to the extent available and the ticket to work program considered for individuals on Social Security - The following should be looked at, when applicable, in all service areas: - Natural supports - Technology - Transportation - Asset building - Personal Care Assistance, when needed - Medicaid Buy-In Program through DPA	- If the recipient has the work maturity skills, a DVR referral should be made - DVR supported employment services are provided for a maximum of 24 months unless, due to special circumstances, the VR counselor and the individual agree to extend services in order to meet the employment goal on the <i>IPE</i> - DVR considers an individual to be successfully employed when the individual 1) has been working for 90 days in a job that is satisfactory to both him/her and the employer; 2) has met the goal for hours of employment as stated in the <i>IPE</i> and the individual placement or intervention on the part of an on-site crew supervisor is directed at maintaining a level of production; 3) is earning the minimum wage; 4) is working in an integrated setting; and 5) has extended supports in place - DVR considers an individual to be successfully self-employed when 1) the business is operational and meeting all federal, state and local laws governing the operation of the business, including maintaining adequate insurance coverage for business requirements; 2) the business is generating sufficient income to cover all required business expenses and the	- The individual and his or her team must develop an individualized long-term support plan prior to transition from vocational rehabilitation; the plan must identify the agency providing the long-term services; the type of services to be provided and the funding source - Long-term support services must include, at a minimum, twice monthly contact with the individual at the work site to assess job stability unless it is determined that off-site monitoring is more appropriate for the individual. Off-site monitoring must consist of at least two face-to-face meetings with the individual and one employer contact monthly - Transportation is allowable with this service to a from a paid job site if no other transportation for the individual is available.

	- Transportation - Asset building - Personal Care Assistance, when needed - Medicaid Buy-In Program through DPA		agreed upon income goal has been reached; and 3) the individual and the VR counselor agree that technical and managerial skills are adequate or in place for ongoing business management and continued growth without further VR services. Due to the time required for businesses to develop and become stable, the follow-up period for self-employment will likely exceed the minimum 90-day period required for all successful closures ▪ The Trust Microenterprise Grant is a good option for additional start up or expansion money for self-employment. DVR funds can be used as match for grant awards up to \$10,000. ▪ Including transportation services in the individual's plan should not result in a decrease in supported/customized employment services ▪ Job Center resources should also be used to the extent available ▪ Ticket-to-Work Partnership Plus funding (DVR and service provider) should also be considered) ▪ The following should be looked at, when applicable, in all service areas: - Natural supports - Technology - Transportation - Asset building - Personal Care Assistance, when needed - Medicaid Buy-In Program through DPA	▪ Job Center resources should also be used to the extent available and the ticket to work program considered for individuals on Social Security ▪ The following should be looked at, when applicable, in all service areas: - Natural supports - Technology - Transportation - Asset building - Personal Care Assistance, when needed - Medicaid Buy-In Program through DPA
--	--	--	---	--

Additional Considerations for Individuals of Transition Age Regarding Employment Services:

Post-Secondary Transition Services (Public Schools):

- Post-secondary transition services are applicable to all students eligible under the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA) beginning the year that the student turns 16, or younger, if determined appropriate by the school Individual Education Program team. Post-secondary transition services include:
 - Identification of appropriate post-secondary goals, based on appropriate transition assessments, relating to training, education, employment and, when appropriate, independent living skills.
 - Transition services, including courses of study, needed to assist the student in reaching those goals.

Pre-Employment Transition Services (DVR):

- Pre-employment transition services (PETS) through the Division of Vocational Rehabilitation are applicable for:
 - A Student with a disability, between the ages of 16 and 21, who is in school and eligible for, and receiving:
 - Special education or related services under Part B of the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA)
 - Or who is an individual with a disability for purposes of section 504;
 - Or is otherwise potentially eligible for Vocations Rehabilitation

Non Duplication of Services (SDS):

- If a participant is enrolled in high school (including school district post-secondary programs), other employment services through SDS cannot be provided during the time those school employment services are being delivered in order to not duplicate services. SDS cannot fund employment services during school hours as IDEA denotes this to be the responsibility of the school districts.
 - An exception may arise if the transition age student has already utilized school district and DVR transition services and obtained competitive integrated employment or the student is no longer receiving school services.
 - If a transition age student/SDS participant (past 18/19 years old) does not have school services any longer, be sure to denote this in the SDS plan of care when requesting an employment service.
 - SDS can support a student in work after school hours and during the summer when school is not in session.

Definitions

Asset Building: Includes activities directly related to the nature and amount of assets an employee with a disability can accumulate in their quest for financial independence and stability; when people with low income accumulate assets rather than simply increasing their income, they are more likely to escape the cycle of poverty permanently. Specific activities include 1) increasing awareness of and use of the Earned Income Tax Credit, which enables low income tax filers to receive a cash payment regardless of whether they pay income taxes; 2) providing Financial Literacy educational programs to provide individuals with skills and knowledge best manage their finances and save money; and 3) helping individuals establish Individual Development Accounts.

Benefits Advisement: Provision of general information about the impact of work on the public benefits of individuals receiving Social Security and other public benefits and the work incentives they can use to secure and maintain employment (Tier 1 Benefits training).

Benefits Analysis: Completing a thorough analysis (Benefits Summary & Analysis or “BSA”) of the impact employment will have on an individual’s benefits by a nationally certified Community Work Incentives Coordinator (CWIC). Specific activities include 1) assessing the potential impacts of employment on an individual’s federal, State and local benefits eligibility and overall financial well-being; 2) providing detailed information to assist the individual in understanding and assessing the potential impacts of employment on his or her life situation and providing specific guidance regarding the effects of various work incentives; and 3) developing a comprehensive framework of possible options available to the individual and projected results for each on his or her life situation **Note:** service providers must complete nationally approved training and field assignments resulting in national accreditation before they can offer this service. The Division of Vocational Rehabilitation requires this service be offered to all Social Security recipients prior to the development of the Individual Plan for Employment (IPE) (Tier II Benefits Training).

Career Advancement Services: Person-centered, comprehensive planning and support services that provide assistance for individuals to advance in competitive employment or self-employment; the outcome of these focused-time-limited services is documentation of the individual’s stated career objective and a career plan used to guide individual employment support more consistent with his or her interests and skills or to explore advancement in his or her chosen career.

Community-Based Situational Assessment: An evaluation of work-related behaviors, strengths and needs in a controlled environment, most likely a real job in the community of interest to the individual. **Note:** reimbursement from the Division of Vocational Rehabilitation is limited to 20 hours per assessment. No more than two situational assessments may be authorized without a manager’s approval.

Competitively Employed (DEED definition): This definition is utilized by the Department of Education and Early Development and defines a youth who has worked for pay at or above the minimum wage in a setting with others who are nondisabled for a period of 20 hours a week for at least 90 days at any time in the year since leaving high school. This includes military employment. Source:

<https://osep.grads360.org/services/PDCService.svc/GetPDCDocumentFile?fileId=4606>

Competitive Employment: Work performed by a person with a disability in an integrated setting at minimum wage or higher and at a rate comparable to workers not experiencing a disability performing the same tasks.

Customized Employment: A flexible process designed to personalize the employment relationship between a job candidate and an employer in a way that meets the needs of both. It is based on an individualized match between the strengths, conditions, and interests of a job candidate and the identified business needs of an employer. Customized Employment utilizes an individualized approach to employment planning and job development — one person at a time . . . one employer at a time. Customized employment often takes the form of 1) *task reassignment* (some of the job tasks of incumbent workers are reassigned to a new employee, thereby allowing the incumbent worker to focus on the critical functions of his/her job (i.e., primary job responsibilities) and complete more of the central work of the job - task reassignment typically takes the form of job creation, whereby a new job description is negotiated based on current, unmet workplace needs); 2) *job carving* (an existing job description is modified — containing one or more, but not all, of the tasks from the original job description); or 3) *job sharing* (two or more people share the tasks and responsibilities of a job based on each other's strengths).

Customized Self-Employment: A form of Customized Employment, which allows for an individual to receive assistance in the creation of an independently owned small business (typically a micro enterprise, under five employees) based on the strengths and dreams of an individual and the unmet needs of a local market while incorporating the individualized planning and support strategies needed for success.

Discovery/Development of Employment Profile/Person-Centered Employment Planning: An intensive process that allows the individual's team to fully understand the individual's strengths, interests and optimal conditions of employment; discovery results in a comprehensive, individualized career profile of the individual clearly identifying his or her unique strengths, needs and potential employment options, including conditions that may be necessary for securing and maintaining employment. The focus is on the job seeker's preferences, talents, life experiences and dreams, rather than on their challenges or limitations; concerns and complexities are considered solvable through negotiation and support, and are not reasons to rule out career options. The career profile is used to develop a task list, identify specific employers to be contacted and prepare a specific proposal for targeted employers. **Note:** reimbursement from the Division of Vocational Rehabilitation is generally limited to 15 hours. **Note:** service providers must complete state-approved training, mentoring and approval of three reports resulting in DVR accreditation before they can offer this service.

DEED: Department of Education and Early Development, providing transition services to students with disabilities edible through the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA).

DVR: Division of Vocational Rehabilitation, which provides individuals with disabilities services related to obtaining and maintaining employment.

Employer Check-In: Regular contact (at least monthly) with the supervisor to assess how the individual is doing and problem solve as needed.

General Career Exploration: Learning about occupations, self-employment and jobs as part of the process of finding a rewarding career path, as well as specific jobs within a particular career, and choosing one's life work.

I/DD: Intellectual/Developmental Disability

Informational Interviewing: Interviewing designed to produce information individuals need to choose or refine a career path, learn how to break in and find out if they have what it takes to succeed.

Information & Referral: Providing information and assisting the individual to obtain services and supports that will enable him or her to maintain their employment (i.e., behavioral health counseling, housing, recreation and leisure activities).

Job Coaching: Training that uses structured intervention techniques to help the individual learn to perform job tasks to the employer's specifications; learn the interpersonal skills necessary to be accepted as a worker at the job site and in related community contacts (if any); and maintain skills related to the job over time. Specific services may include any or all of the following: 1) learning about specific job requirements and duties by spending as much time as necessary at the job site; 2) preparing detailed job and task analyses to serve as the basis for developing training strategies; 3) using structured training techniques for teaching job performance skills and job-related skills; 4) identifying and using adaptations, accommodations and technology that will enable the individual to be more successful and independent on the job; 5) ensuring individual success by providing advocacy at the work site, in the individual's residence or community and with external agencies such as the Social Security Administration; 6) identifying and using natural supports; 7) providing or coordinating travel training or transportation options; 8) continually evaluating and monitoring the individual's performance and progress; 9) fading as the individual becomes more proficient and requires less job coach intervention; 10) regular monitoring, check-in with the individual and the supervisor, and problem solving assistance, counseling and guidance as needed; and 11) job retention services as needed.

Job Placement Assistance/Job Development: Process of locating and securing a permanent job in the competitive labor market for the individual, including a referral to a specific job resulting in an interview, whether or not the individual obtained the job. **Note:** preferential hire with the State and Schedule A for Federal placements are included in this category.

Job Search Assistance: Includes activities that support and assist an individual in searching for and/or obtaining an appropriate job; examples of job development/job search assistance include, but are not limited to job development, job carving, help in preparing a resume specific to a targeted job, help in posting resumes electronically for a targeted job, developing interviewing skills for a targeted job and contacting employers on behalf of the individual to develop appropriate accommodations and/or modify job duties.

Job Search Training: Training for job seekers about how to 1) put together a resume to present their background and skills; 2) networking to develop a broad list of contact – people they’ve met through various social, professional and business functions – and encouraging them to give you job leads, offer you advice about a particular company or industry and introduce them to others so they can expand their networks; 3) search for a job matching their knowledge, skills and abilities; and 4) interview for a job.

Job Shadowing: Provides job seekers with opportunities to gather information on a wide variety of career possibilities before deciding where they want to focus their attention. Job shadows involve brief visits to a variety of workplaces, during which time the job seeker observe, “shadow” and ask questions of individual workers.

Job Tryout: Time-limited, unpaid situational assessment that provides the job seeker with an opportunity to gain first-hand, hands-on knowledge of the requirements of a job, assess interests, skills and abilities and determine “fit” with the job requirements.

Natural Supports: Working with the supervisor or co-workers so they train and provide on-the-job supports the individual; services may include mentoring by a person at a higher level of the company who counsels the individual and helps guide his or her career.

Other Workplace Support Services: Includes services not specifically related to job skill training that enable the individual to be successful in integrating into the job setting (i.e., regular observation or supervision; assessment of the individual’s stability and what services are needed to maintain stability based on a minimum of twice-monthly meetings with the individual, regular contact with the supervisor, coordination with family or residential provider).

Peer Support and Mentoring: Involves employed people with disabilities helping other people with disabilities secure and maintain employment; peer employment support is used to build hope and support the belief that employment is a possibility for everyone through positive role modeling; provide emotional support and advice with a higher level of credibility through the shared experience; assist with navigation of and access to the employment system; and expand social networks and develop close relationships with people who have similar experiences. Specific activities may include 1) sharing of personal stories regarding obtaining and maintaining employment; 2) providing information about the resources they used to go to work (e.g., Social Security Administration work incentives, Ticket-to-Work vocational rehabilitation, job center); 3) providing advice on developing personal network to help them in their employment search; 4) providing advice and guidance on appropriate interpersonal skills and work behaviors; 5) problem-solving as needed; and/or 6) helping the individual acclimate to the workplace.

PETS: Pre-Employment Transition Services which work to develop interpersonal skills of communication, attitude, teamwork, problem solving, and professionalism to obtain workplace readiness and are offered through the Division of Vocational Rehabilitation (DVR) to in school youth (16-21 years) who have a disability who are receiving: Special education or related services under Part B of the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA), or who is an individual with a disability for purposes of section 504, or is otherwise potentially eligible for Vocations Rehabilitation.

Self-Employment Assistance and Coaching: Assisting the individual to maintain and grow his or her business and continue to generate income to achieve economic self-sufficiency or to significantly augment non-wage income; services may include providing guidance and expertise on finance, operations or production, marketing and the law and/or providing appropriate accommodations or assistive technology needed by the individual.

Self-Employment Training, Planning and Start-Up: Providing assistance to support self-employment, including 1) aiding the individual to identify potential business opportunities; 2) assisting in the development of a business plan, including potential sources of business financing and other assistance in developing and launching a business; 3) identifying the support necessary for the individual to operate the business; and 4) ongoing assistance, counseling and guidance once the business has been launched.

Skill Building: Training to develop *hard skills*, which are those skills that are specific to a particular career field or job (i.e., filing, operating machinery, facility with spreadsheets, measuring and cutting wood and handling a hammer or nail gun, writing computer programs). The hard skills needed for a particular position are also likely to vary a great deal from one position to the next, and may also vary between jobs within the same career field (e.g., a computer programming position may require specific application, system, database or HTML skills depending on the specific position.) Some hard skills are learned on-the-job while others require short-term or long-term training or education.

SDS: Senior and Disabilities Services, a Division of the Department of Health and Social Services, which is responsible for Medicaid waiver services.

Soft Skills Assistance: Assisting the individual to enhance his or her interactions with the supervisor and co-workers, job performance and career prospect on an as needed basis.

Technology: Using a device, piece of equipment or product system, whether acquired commercially off the shelf, modified or customized to improve, increase or maintain the functional capacity and independence of the individual at the job site. This also includes any service that directly assists the individual in the selection, acquisition or use of the device.

Transportation: Providing or arranging transportation to and from work; may include adequate training in the use of public transportation vehicles and systems and use of inclusive natural supports when available.

Volunteer Work: Involves an individual offering his or her services, free of charge, typically to a non-profit organization to gain experience in a career or job of interest. As further defined as a component of pre-employment services, volunteer work is short-term for purposes of gathering information about the individual's skills, abilities and interests.

Work Incentive Advising: Builds upon benefits analysis and planning services and includes periodic updates of an individual's specific information, reassessment of benefit(s) and overall impact, education and advisement, and additional services for monitoring and managing work incentives to ensure the individual's success in his or her employment. Specific activities include 1) providing ongoing direct assistance to an individual in the

development of a comprehensive, long-term work plan to guide the effective use of Federal, State and local work incentives; 2) assisting the individual to resolve problems related to their benefits and continuation of work; 3) providing ongoing, comprehensive work incentives monitoring and management assistance to employed individuals; and 4) providing long-term work incentives management on a scheduled, continuous basis, allowing for the planning and provision of supports at regular checkpoints, as well as critical transition points in the individual's receipt of benefits, improvement of medical condition, employment, and changes in a job such as reduced or increased hours, overtime and reclassification to different pay rates.

Work Maturity/Readiness Skills Training: Training about personal attributes that enhance an individual's interactions, job performance and career prospects. Unlike *hard skills*, which are about a person's skill set and ability to perform a certain type of task or activity, soft skills are interpersonal, broadly applicable both in and outside the workplace and include proficiencies such as communication, punctuality, cooperation, exhibiting proper behaviors, seeking assistance as necessary, ability to remain calm under pressure, and a maintaining a positive flexible attitude.